

Windows

If there's anything you really *need* to work faster with, it's good old Windows. When you combine keyboard shortcuts, *Start > Run* commands and a selection of command-line tools (all covered here, of course), you can spend an entire day with Windows without ever having to touch your mouse. We're using XP as our reference—it's still the most widely used version—and Vista-only shortcuts (there are very few) will be marked as such.

1.1 Windows Keyboard Shortcuts

Most of these have become second nature to you already, but there are a lot more that should.

1.1.1. General Shortcuts

These are applicable to nearly all Windows programs.

[F1]

Display Help. When in Windows Explorer or viewing the desktop, this shows you Windows Help. Otherwise, shows you the active program's documentation.

[Ctrl] + [C]

Copy the selected item or text

[Ctrl] + [X]

Cut the selected item or text

[Ctrl] + [V]

Paste the selected item or text

[Ctrl] + [Z]

Undo the last action

[Ctrl] + [Y]

Redo the last action